All machines that are part of the render farm need to have installed a full version of 3ds Max or just the 3ds Max core if the machine is only a render node. Jobs submitted to the network must be submitted from a machine that has a full authorized copy of 3ds Max. In addition, all machines that render must have access to a common network server that can receive the rendered frames.

5.8.1 Manager

The manager program controls all render servers in the network. There is typically one manager machine per network. This program must be active and running for network rendering to be active. When the program is run, the manager window will appear on the machine. By choosing Edit > General Settings, you can configure how the manager operates. You can set the number of servers that can be assigned to a job and the number of jobs that can be active at a time. The body of the window will report the status of the rendering process and can be minimised if needed.

5.8.2 Server

The server controls the rendering process on an individual machine. When the server is assigned a job from the manager, the server launches a copy of 3ds Max and renders the specified frames. The server must be able to see the network drive where the frames will be rendered.

5.8.3 Server Assigning Jobs

After the manager and server are active, jobs can be assigned to Backburner. This is done via the Render Scene window. When the Net Render box is active, 3ds Max will bring up the Network Job Assignment window when the scene is rendered. The window will first come up with no manager active. Pressing the Connect button will allow you to choose the manager. After this is done, a list of active jobs and servers will appear. You can submit the job to all servers or just selected servers.

5.8.4 Server Monitor

Render jobs can be monitored and managed by using the Backburner monitor program. This Program lists the active jobs and server assignments. It allows you to reassign, reprioritize, and delete jobs.